

1st PEMNet National Extension Conference 2026

ABSTRACT TEMPLATE

Theme: **HEIs at the Forefront of Transformative Extension: Advancing Evidence-Based, Inclusive, Sustainable, and Resilient Community Development**

Instructions: Complete all sections. Select only one paper category and one thematic area. Use clear, evidence-based statements and avoid unsupported outcome or impact claims.

A. Paper Information

1. Title of the Extension Project Paper	Lighting the Light Through Project LIGHT: Healing, Skills, and Reintegration for Vulnerable Girls
2. Author/s and Institutional Affiliation/s Note: Use an asterisk (*) after the name of the project leader. If the presenter is not the project leader, write "paper presenter" after the name	Jerame N. Gamboa, EdD, PhD John Ryan S. Tolentino, MAEd Jennifer S. Baluyut, MAEd Emmanuel R. Perez, MAEd Pampanga State University College of Education- Laboratory High School
3. Name and Email Address of Corresponding Author	Jerame N. Gamboa, EdD, PhD [jngamboa@pampangastateu.edu.ph]
3. Paper Category	☐ Completed Extension Project Paper ☐ Ongoing Extension Project Paper
4. Thematic Area (choose 1 only)	☐ Food Production, Agriculture, Fisheries, and Natural Resource Systems ☐ Health, Nutrition, Wellness, and Community Care ☐ Education, Literacy, Skills Development, and Lifelong Learning ☐ Livelihood, Entrepreneurship, Cooperatives, MSMEs, and Local Economic Development ☐ Environment, Climate Action, Disaster Risk Reduction, and Community Resilience

B. Extended Abstract Narrative

Guide: Write concise paragraphs under each required component.

5. Community or Sectoral Need Addressed

Briefly describe in not more than 150 words the validated community, institutional, or sectoral need addressed by the project.

The DSWD Haven for Girls in Magalang, Pampanga, provides residential care to young women classified as victims or in conflict with the law — a vulnerable group grappling with unresolved emotional trauma, disrupted education, absence of marketable livelihood skills, and limited prospects

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for safe reintegration. Following a formal request dated April 22, 2022, a thorough needs assessment and stakeholder consultations were conducted to validate gaps in holistic care, educational assistance, livelihood training, and emotional guidance. Careful pre-implementation planning ensured interventions were evidence-driven, gender-responsive, trauma-informed, and tailored to the all-female beneficiaries' recovery and developmental needs.

6. Project Objectives

State the main objective/s of the extension project.

The main objective of Project LIGHT is to provide holistic interventions that support healing, personal growth, and economic readiness, preparing girls in the shelter who are victims or in conflict with the law for independent and productive lives.

Specifically, it aims to:

- A. Enhance emotional resilience, responsible decision-making, and self-efficacy while reducing fear, anxiety, and negative emotions;
- B. improve physical well-being through outreach activities;
- C. Equip participants with practical livelihood skills in food processing, cosmetology, dressmaking, and handicrafts; and
- D. Foster hope and a positive outlook to facilitate smooth reintegration into families and communities.

7. Extension Methods, Strategies, or Activities Implemented

Describe in not more than 300 words the major extension approaches, methods, strategies, or activities implemented.

Project LIGHT employs a dual-component, trauma-informed, and gender-responsive framework integrating psychosocial support and livelihood skills training, flexibly delivered to align with shelter operations.

Psychosocial and personal development activities include individual and group guidance and counseling, emotional regulation sessions, life skills education in basic communication, conflict resolution, values formation, and health and wellness outreach.

Technical skills training covers: food processing (salted egg production); cosmetology (haircutting, hairstyling, manicure-pedicure, hair coloring and treatment); dressmaking; and handicrafts including basic drawing and fuzzy-wire flower making.

All activities were designed based on validated needs assessment findings and coordinated quarterly with DSWD to ensure safe, appropriate, and inclusive implementation.

8. Key Outputs, Emerging Results, and Evidence of Outcomes, Adoption, or Utilization

Briefly present in not more than 300 words the documented outputs and emerging results of the project. Include available evidence of outcomes, adoption, utilization, capability-building, institutional change, or public value, if applicable. Claims must be supported by verifiable evidence.

a. Major Outputs or Emerging Results

Implemented from January 2022 through December 2026, Project LIGHT has delivered five full years of integrated outreach programs and recurring training cycles covering psychosocial support

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and four vocational competency areas, alongside continuous counseling and wellness sessions for all resident beneficiaries at the DSWD Haven for Girls. Through regular individual and group guidance, emotional regulation workshops, and life-skills modules, participants demonstrated measurable improvements in emotional stability, self-confidence, responsible decision-making, interpersonal communication, and conflict resolution, while showing reduced anxiety and improved outlook toward the future.

In livelihood skills training, beneficiaries acquired market-ready, practical competencies across four priority domains: food processing (salted egg production), cosmetology (haircutting, styling, manicure-pedicure, coloring, and treatment), dressmaking, and handicrafts (basic drawing and fuzzy-wire flower making). Many successfully produced finished goods and progressed from basic to proficient levels of hands-on skill.

Ongoing monitoring — including attendance tracking, pre-post assessments, direct observation, and quarterly stakeholder reviews — confirms that activities were highly relevant, well-organized, appropriately paced, and fully inclusive, consistently matching individual learning needs and shelter operational constraints. High participation and completion rates across all cohorts reflect strong acceptability and engagement, directly supporting the project's dual goals of psychosocial healing and vocational empowerment as a foundation for safe, sustainable reintegration.

b. Evidence of Outcomes, Adoption, or Utilization

[Type response here. If not yet available, write: "Not yet available."]

Systematic monitoring through regular site visits, attendance tracking, direct observation, pre- and post-activity assessments, and structured feedback surveys revealed consistently high client satisfaction across all program components, confirming responsiveness to identified needs and achievement of core objectives. Gender-sensitive indicators demonstrated uniformly positive engagement and acceptance. Beneficiaries exhibited increased self-confidence, emotional resilience, and vocational readiness, supporting their ongoing recovery and future reintegration.

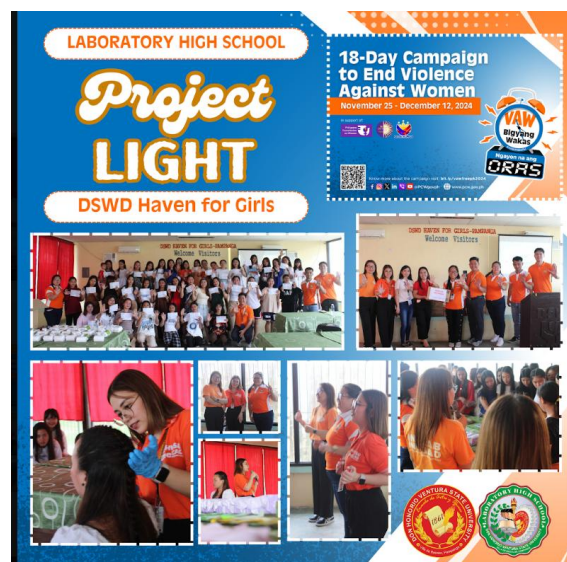
Moreover, based on the Client Satisfaction Survey conducted by the Extension Services Office of Pampanga State University, the extension project garnered a numerical rating of 96.5 and 95.115 for Academic Year 2024-2025 and 2025-2026 respectively, proving a high rating of satisfaction among the beneficiaries.

c. Supporting Documents/Evidence Available

[Examples: attendance sheets, monitoring reports, photos, testimonials, adoption records, partnership agreements, policy issuances, utilization reports, or other proof.]

Attendance sheets, quarterly monitoring and evaluation reports, activity documentation and photos, client satisfaction survey results, DSWD partnership agreement / MOA, needs assessment and consultation records, pre and post activity assessment forms, narrative accomplishment reports (2022–2026).

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9. Sustainability Direction or Next Steps

Explain in not more than 150 words how the project will be sustained, institutionalized, scaled, or improved, or state the next steps for ongoing projects.

The project will continue delivering advanced training modules until the program term concludes. Market linkages are being developed for beneficiary-produced goods to support potential livelihood income. The memorandum of agreement with DSWD will be renewed to expand coverage, while shelter personnel will receive capacity building to continue basic activities independently. Project LIGHT is targeted for integration into Pampanga State University's regular extension services, with plans to expand into entrepreneurship, financial literacy, job placement linkages, and post-reintegration follow-up support.

C. Keywords

Community Extension; Holistic Development; Livelihood Skills; Psychosocial Support; Vulnerable Girls

For PEMNet Abstract Review Committee Use Only:

- ☐ Recommended for Acceptance
- ☐ Not Recommended for Acceptance

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Reviewed by: _____
Chair, PEMNet Scientific / Abstract Review Committee